

OPINION (AGREE / DISAGREE)

"To what extent do you agree or disagree?" / "Do you agree or disagree?"

1. Full-time university students spend a lot of time studying. Some say they should do other activities too. To what extent do you agree or disagree?
2. Housing is a basic necessity for everyone. Therefore, the government should provide free housing for people who cannot afford to pay for it. To what extent do you agree or disagree?
3. The availability of entertainment such as video games on handheld devices is harmful to individuals and to the society they live in. To what extent do you agree or disagree?
4. Some people think the money spent on developing technology for space exploration is wasteful. There are more beneficial ways to spend this money. To what extent do you agree or disagree?
5. Restoration of old buildings in many cities involves enormous government expenditure. It would be more beneficial to spend this money on building new houses and roads. To what extent do you agree or disagree?
6. Some people find advertisements amusing or annoying and they are not influenced by this when they shop. To what extent do you agree or disagree?
7. The tendency of human beings to copy one another is shown in the popularity of fashions in clothes and other consumer goods. Do you agree or disagree?
8. Solving environmental problems should be the responsibility of an international organization rather than each national government. Do you agree or disagree?
9. Children can learn effectively by watching television. Therefore, they should be encouraged to watch television regularly at home and at school. To what extent do you agree or disagree?
10. Museums and art galleries should concentrate on works that show history and culture of their own country rather than the works of other parts of the world. To what extent do you agree or disagree with this opinion?
11. There are several factors that motivate people to stay in the workforce, and money is the most important factor. To what extent do you agree or disagree?
12. Government funding for space exploration is often viewed as a waste of resources. It would be more beneficial to allocate this budget to addressing urgent issues on Earth. To what extent do you agree or disagree?
13. Some people believe that everyone has a right to have access to university education and the governments should make it free for all students no matter what financial background they have. To what extent do you agree or disagree?
14. Crime rates are likely to decline due to the advancements in technology, which will help to prevent and solve crimes in an easier way. Do you agree or disagree?

- 15.** Some groups of people have benefited from modern communications technology but some people do not benefit at all. To what extent do you agree or disagree?
- 16.** If a product is good or meets people's needs, they will buy it. Therefore, advertising is unnecessary and no more than entertainment. To what extent do you agree or disagree?
- 17.** Some people think that the best way to improve road safety is to increase the minimum legal age for driving a car or motorbike. To what extent do you agree or disagree?
- 18.** It is the responsibility of schools to teach children good behavior in addition to providing formal education. To what extent do you agree or disagree?
- 19.** Some people say that the main aim of advertising is to improve the sales of products that people do not really need. To what extent do you agree or disagree?
- 20.** Most employers nowadays put increasing emphasis on social skills. Some people believe that social skills are important in addition to good qualifications for job success. To what extent do you agree or disagree?
- 21.** The main purpose of advertising is to increase the sales of products that people don't really need. To what extent do you agree or disagree?
- 22.** With the rapid advancement of communication technology: smartphones, tablets and other mobile devices, some people believe that the disadvantages outweigh the advantages. To what extent do you agree or disagree?
- 23.** Government money should be used to support children in school for sports rather than to support professional sports and arts that perform for the general public. To what extent do you agree?
- 24.** It is a natural process for animal species to become extinct (e.g dinosaurs, dodos, etc.). There is no reason why people should try to prevent this from happening. To what extent do you agree or disagree?
- 25.** Some people think that governments should focus on reducing environmental pollution and housing problems to help people to prevent illness and disease. To what extent do you agree or disagree?
- 26.** Students today can access information online, so libraries are no longer necessary. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

DISCUSSION (BOTH VIEWS)

"Discuss both views and give your opinion."

1. Some people think that governments should pay for education and health care, while others believe that it is not their responsibility. Discuss both views and give your own opinion.
2. Many people think cheap air travel should be encouraged because it gives ordinary people the freedom to travel further. However, others think that this leads to environmental problems, so air travel should be more expensive in order to decrease pollution. Discuss both views and give your opinion.
3. In many countries, a small number of people earn extremely high salaries. Some people believe that this is good for the country, but others think that governments should not allow salaries above a certain level. Discuss both these views and give your own opinion.
4. Some people think that it is best to live in a horizontal city while others think of a vertical city. Discuss both views and give your opinion.
5. Some people think rapid population growth in cities benefits people who live there, while others believe that it has negative impacts. Discuss both these views and give your own opinion.
6. Some people say it is the government's responsibility to transport children to school, while others believe parents should transport their children to school. Discuss both views and give your opinion.
7. Some people say that the increasing business and cultural contact between countries has positive effects. Others say it would lead to the loss of national identities. Discuss both views and give your opinion.
8. Some people think that children should be taught at school to recycle materials and avoid waste. Other people believe that children should be taught this at home. Discuss both opinions and give your own opinion.
9. Some people think that it is more effective for students to study in a group while others believe that it is better for them to study alone. Discuss both views and give your own opinion.
10. Some scientists think that there are intelligent life forms on other planets, and a message should be sent to contact them. Other scientists think that it is a bad idea and would be dangerous. Discuss both the views and give your opinion.
11. In many countries, the government likes to spend more money on the arts. Some people agree with this. However, others think the government should spend more on health and education. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.
12. Some people think that family has the most powerful influence on a child's development, while others believe that other factors (friends, television, music,...) have a stronger effect. Discuss both views and give your own opinion.

- 13.** In many parts of the world, people do research on their family history. Some people believe that finding out about previous generations is a useful thing to do. However, others believe that it is better to focus on present and future generations. Discuss both views and give your opinion.
- 14.** Some people think history has nothing or little to tell us, but others think that studying the past history can help us better understand the present. Please discuss the two views and give your own opinion.
- 15.** Some people think that children should start school at a very early age, but others believe that children should go to school until they are older. Discuss both views and give your opinion.
- 16.** The government should spend money on sport facilities for training top athletes while others argue that they should spend money on sports facilities for everybody. Discuss both views and give your opinion.
- 17.** Some people think that people should be given the right to use fresh water as they like. Others believe governments should strictly control the use of fresh water. Discuss both views and give your own opinion.
- 18.** Some people think that museums should be enjoyable places to entertain people, while others believe that the purpose of the museums is to educate. Discuss both views and give your own opinion.
- 19.** Some people think hosting major international sporting events brings a lot of advantages to a country, while others believe there are more disadvantages. Discuss both views and give your own opinion.
- 20.** Some people think that robots are very important to humans' future development, while others think that they are dangerous and have negative effects on society. Discuss both views and give your opinion.
- 21.** In many countries, a small number of people earn extremely high salaries. Some people believe that this is good for the country, but others think that the government should not allow salaries above certain level. Discuss the view and give your opinion.
- 22.** Some people think a job not only provides income but also social life. Others think it is better to develop social life with people you do not work with. Discuss both views and give your opinion.
- 23.** Some people believe that women should play an equal role as men in military force, while others think women are not suitable for these kinds of jobs. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

TWO-PART / DIRECT QUESTION

Asks two distinct questions (e.g., "Why?" + "Is it positive?")

1. Parents are putting a lot of pressure on their children to succeed. What are the reasons for this? Is it a positive or negative development?
2. In today's world of advanced science and technology, we still greatly value our artists such as musicians, painters, and writers. What can the arts tell us about life that science and technology cannot?
3. In the past, people lived in the same place throughout their lives. However, it is common that now people change their place and often live in different places during their life. What are the reasons for this? Is it a positive or negative development?
4. In today's world of advanced science and technology, we still greatly value our artists such as musicians, painters and writers. What can the arts tell us about life that science and technology cannot?
5. Some countries have introduced laws to limit working hours for employees. Why are these laws introduced? Do you think they are a positive or negative development?
6. Nowadays more and more people want to get things done instantly (services, information, tasks). Why is this? Do you think this is a positive or negative development?
7. In the past, people used to travel abroad to look for many differences from their home country. Nowadays, cities throughout the world are becoming more and more similar. What are the reasons? Do the advantages outweigh the disadvantages?
8. People used to live in the same city throughout their lives, but now they change where they live several times. What is the cause? Do you think it is a positive or negative trend?
9. People used to live in the same city throughout their lives, but now they change where they live several times. What is the cause? Do you think it is a positive or negative trend?

ADVANTAGE / DISADVANTAGE

"Do the advantages outweigh the disadvantages?" / "Positive or negative development?"

1. In the modern era, an increasing number of people perform daily activities such as working, communicating, and shopping online. Is this a positive or negative development?
 2. Nowadays young people are admiring media and sports stars, even though they do not set a good example. Do you think this is a positive or negative development?
 3. Nowadays it is easy to apply for and be given a credit card. However, some people experience problems when they are not able to pay their debt back. In your opinion, do the advantages of credit cards outweigh the disadvantages?
 4. In the modern world it is possible to shop, work and communicate with people via the internet and live without any face-to-face contact with others. Is it a positive or negative development in your opinion?
 5. More and more students are choosing to study at colleges and universities in a foreign country. Do the benefits of studying abroad outweigh the drawbacks?
 6. In the past, knowledge was stored in books. Today, people store knowledge on the internet. Do the advantages of this outweigh the disadvantages?
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PROBLEM / SOLUTION

"What are the causes? What solutions can be proposed?"

1. In many parts of the world, children and teenagers are committing more crimes. Why is this happening? How should they be punished?
2. The population of some cities is growing rapidly. What are the effects on people living in these cities? What solutions can you propose to maintain a good quality of life in urban areas?
3. In many countries, the amount of household waste like food packaging is increasing. What are the causes of this problem? What measures could be taken to reduce it?
4. Many criminals commit further crimes as soon as they are released from prison. What do you think are the causes of this? What possible solutions can you suggest?
5. Many students find it is harder to study at university or college compared to when they were in grade school. Why is this? What are some possible solutions for this problem?